

Muhammad Talal Ahmed

Cybersecurity Analyst

✉ mail@talal.com 📍 Pakistan 🔗 talal.com 📄 talal

PROFILE

Cybersecurity Enthusiast with a strong foundation in computer science, currently pursuing a bachelor's degree. Passionate about ethical hacking, network security, and threat detection. Actively building hands-on skills through coursework, personal projects, and Capture the Flag (CTF) events.

EDUCATION

Sargodha University, *BS Computer Science*

2022 – 2026

CGPA: 3.80

Relevant Coursework: Network Security, Information Security, Artificial Intelligence

Activities: President of Programming Society, Managed university CTF team

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SOC Analyst, *ITSOLERA PVT LTD*

Jan 2026 – Present

- Deployed Wazuh SIEM
- Configured File Integrity Monitoring (FIM)
- Implemented pfSense software firewall
- Integrated pfSense firewall logs into Wazuh

Cybersecurity Fellow, *Buildables*

Aug 2025 – Nov 2025

- Executed a controlled cyber attack simulation to validate vulnerabilities and assess organizational defense posture.
- Conducted SOC monitoring and traffic analysis to detect intrusions and map Indicators of Compromise (IOCs).
- Authored incident response reports and security policies to drive strategic system hardening.

IT Intern, *Jauharabad Sugar Mills Pvt Ltd*

Jul 2025 – Sep 2025

- Assisted the CCTV installation team and helped configure OLT devices for new camera deployments.
- Monitored network performance and firewall traffic using pfSense, identifying issues and ensuring stable connectivity.
- Explored and worked with enterprise-level network configurations, gaining exposure to VLANs, routing, and access control.
- Provided day-to-day IT support for staff, troubleshooting system, network, and hardware issues.

Cybersecurity Fellow, *Bytewise*

Jun 2024 – Sep 2024

- Learned professional Cybersecurity practices
- Mentored by an Industry Professional

PROJECTS

pfSense Firewall Security Monitoring,

Feb 2026

at ITSOLERA PVT LTD

- Implemented pfSense software firewall and enforced network access control and traffic filtering rules
- Integrated pfSense firewall logs into Wazuh using rsyslog for centralized log monitoring
- Analyzed blocked traffic, firewall events, and security alerts via the Wazuh dashboard
- Designed secure LAN/WAN network segmentation and restricted firewall administrative access

Wazuh SIEM & File Integrity Monitoring,

Jan 2026

at ITSOLERA PVT LTD

- Deployed and configured Wazuh SIEM (manager + agents) for centralized security monitoring
- Enabled real-time log collection (authentication, system, and application logs)
- Implemented File Integrity Monitoring (FIM) with real-time detection on critical system paths

TryHackMe - SOC L1 Capstone

Jul 2025

- Investigated three full-chain SOC incidents (Boogeyman 1/2/3) using ELK (Elastic Stack) for log analysis and Kibana dashboards.
- Performed digital forensics on email artifacts, LNK files, and malicious attachments (shortcut files, HTA, VBA macros) to trace threat actor activity.
- Analyzed PowerShell logs, parsed JSON logs (with jq), and decoded obfuscated commands to reconstruct attacker behavior.
- Used Wireshark to examine network captures and identified C2 (command & control) communication channels.
- Conducted domain forensic investigations via Kibana: discovered privilege escalation, lateral movement, credential dumping with Mimikatz, persistence, and ransomware deployment in the final chapter.

End-to-End Cyber Attack Lifecycle Analysis

Nov 2025

- Executed a controlled attack simulation to assess security posture, utilizing offensive techniques to validate defenses and performing SOC-style monitoring to detect intrusions.
- Analyzed forensic artifacts to map Indicators of Compromise (IOCs) and authored strategic security policies to drive remediation and system hardening.

Machine Learning for Polymorphic Malware Detection,

Jun 2025

Semester Project

- Built a system to detect advanced Windows malware using behavioral analysis of API calls.
- Used real malware samples and sandbox reports to train models like Random Forest and XGBoost.
- Reduced false positives and improved detection accuracy with data preprocessing and model tuning.
- Achieved over 96% detection rate and under 5% false positive rate on new malware.

CERTIFICATES

TryHackMe SOC Level 1 Analyst

71 hands-on labs introduced a wide array of tools and real-life analysis scenarios

Google Cybersecurity Specialization

8 Course Specialization covering all aspects of Cybersecurity

VOLUNTEERING

Programming Society, *President*

Feb 2025 – Present | Sargodha University

- Leading a team to organize workshops, competitions, and collaborative projects for students across all semesters
- Mentored junior members and coordinated with faculty to align events with academic and career development goals
- Expanded active membership and introduced domain-specific tracks (Web Dev, AI, Cybersecurity)